THE FARM

HOTEL AL MOUDIRA
LUXOR

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WELCOME TO THE FARM

Just beyond the gardens lies the quiet heart of Al Moudira: twelve hectares of fields, orchards and workshops, where much of what you eat, sleep on and hold during your stay is grown or made by hand.

We begin at reception with karkadeh, the ruby hibiscus drink of Upper Egypt. Early in the walk, at the paper studio, each guest is given a fan made there by hand.

EACH MORNING

9:30 to 11:00, with the compliments of the hotel

MEETING AT RECEPTION

THE FARM TEAM OF AL MOUDIRA

This booklet follows our morning walk and is yours to keep.
Made on sugarcane paper from our paper studio.

HOW IT BEGAN

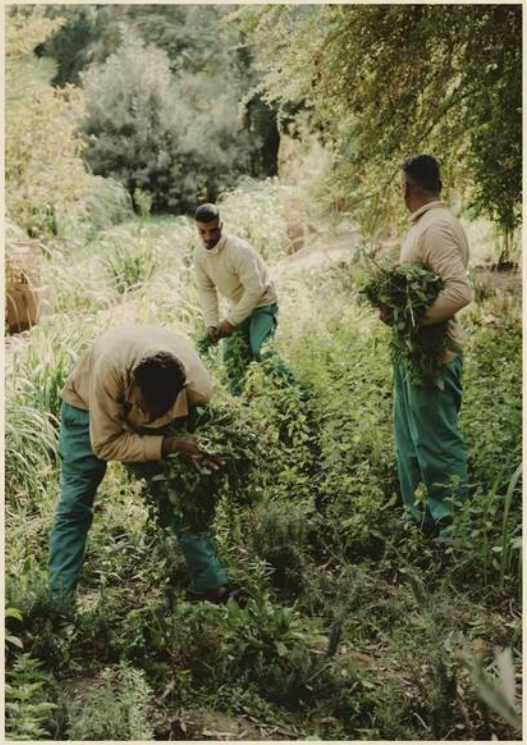
In 2002, Zeina Aboukheir found a parcel of desert and a spring on Luxor's West Bank. With the architect Olivier Sednaoui and the craftsmen of the neighbouring villages, she built Al Moudira from rescued doors, painted glass and hand cut tiles.

In 2022, Al Moudira passed to the new owner, who gave the hotel a farm of its own, on land that had lain uncultivated: fields to feed the kitchens, and workshops where the crafts Zeina had always championed are practised every day.

Al Moudira takes its name from her team's word for Zeina: *the lady boss.*



The dovecotes, in the last of the afternoon light



Gathering herbs for the Farm Kitchen

THE FARM TODAY

Twelve Hectares

Vegetables, fruit and herbs, tended by hand. Most of what reaches our kitchens is grown here

A Working Farm

Whatever is left returns to the land as compost or feed for the animals

The People

Most of the gardeners and artisans come from the villages around the hotel, and many have been with us for years

To the Table

What grows here sets the menu at the Moudira Farm Kitchen, written each day by Chef Gioconda Scott

In Season Now

Ducklings, sugarcane and hibiscus

OCTOBER

Look for the buffalo milk crème caramel with caramelised figs.
Moudira Farm Kitchen, lunch from 12:00 and dinner from 18:00.

THE WALK

Reception
Karkadeh and a warm welcome
9:30

The Workshops
The tailor, the bookbinder, the potter and the paper studio

The Animals
Ostriches, deer, peacocks, cows and goats

The Artisans' Row
Copper, palm leaf and alabaster

The Dovecotes and Olive Groves
The poultry, khayamiya and the Stable

MOUDIRA FARM KITCHEN
Coffee or tea together beneath the palms
10:45

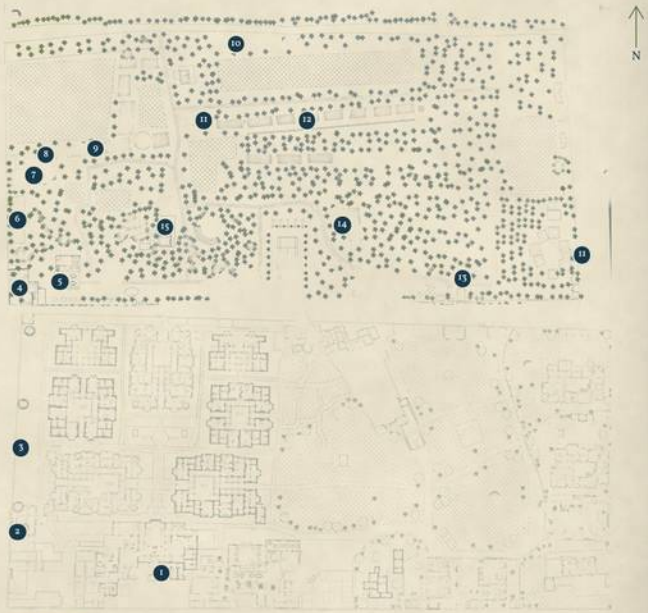
A gentle loop, its order set by the rhythm of the morning.
Comfortable shoes and a hat are recommended.



The dairy herd, in the shade of the palms

THE MAP

THE FARM



THE HOTEL

1 Reception
2 The tailor
3 Bookbinding
4 The pottery
5 The paper studio
6 Weaving and kilim
7 Upholstery
8 Antiques
9 The animals
10 The artisans' row
11 The dovecotes
12 The poultry
13 Khayamiya
14 The Stable
15 Moudira Farm Kitchen

THE WORKSHOPS

The Tailor

Trained by the Neapolitan shirtmaker Luca Avitabile

WITH RAMEZ

Bookbinding

Leather notebooks with gilded edges. This booklet was bound here

WITH AHMED

The Pottery

Take a turn at the wheel; small pieces are fired in time to take home

WITH KARIM

The Paper Studio

Sheets pulled by hand from sugarcane fibre, and your fan

WITH ENAS

Weaving

The cottons you find across the hotel, woven on the loom

WITH MOSTAFA

You are welcome to watch in every workshop.
Kindly ask before taking a portrait.



Palm leaf, woven by hand



Stitching with the women of the khayamiya workshop

THE WORKSHOPS

Kilim

Flat woven rugs in the patterns of Upper Egypt

WITH MOHAMED

Upholstery

Where the sofas, chairs and cushions of the hotel are covered by hand

WITH AYMAN

Antiques

Pieces gathered from across Egypt, restored and painted by hand

WITH ABU AMMAR

Copper

Trays, coffee pots and lanterns, hammered and pierced by hand

WITH SALAMA

Palm Leaf

Chairs and baskets from the ribs of the date palm

WITH AHMED

Work from the farm awaits at Madu Boutique
and the Moudira Artisan Show Room.

THE WORKSHOPS

Alabaster

Upper Egypt's luminous stone, carved into vases and candle holders

WITH MOHAMED

Khayamiya

Egypt's centuries old art of appliqué, stitched by hand

WITH RASHA

MAKE A PIECE OF YOUR OWN

At the pottery, the paper studio and the alabaster workshop, our artisans would be delighted to guide you

ARRANGED THROUGH RECEPTION

Some pieces take days to finish;
we can keep them for your next visit or send them home.



In the cool of the dovecote



At the Stable

THE ANIMALS

Rosetta and Ghazal
Our horses, trained by Omar

Honey and Hibiscus
Our camels, in no hurry

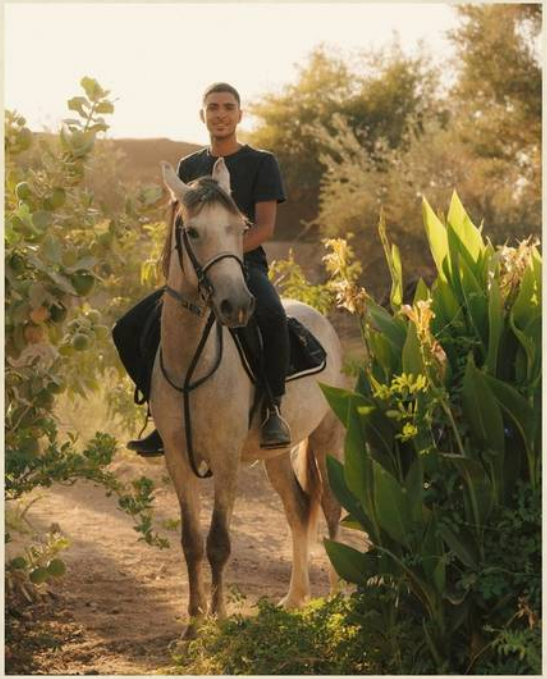
Sultan
The gentlest donkey on the West Bank

Ostriches, Deer and Peacocks
Curious, graceful and a little proud

The Dairy Herd and Goats
For the milk and cheese at breakfast

The Poultry
Ducks, chickens and turkeys
IN THE CARE OF NAGWA, ZEINAB AND DONIA

This October the duck enclosure is full of ducklings.
Rides from the Stable may be arranged at reception.



Omar, riding out from the Stable

GOOD TO KNOW

What to Wear

Comfortable shoes and a hat; the paths are uneven and the morning sun generous

Photographs

Welcome in most workshops. Kindly ask before taking a portrait

Taking a Piece Home

Work from the farm may be charged to your room

Thanking the Artisans

Never expected, always appreciated: directly, or in a sealed envelope at reception

Beyond the Walk

Ride out from the Stable, cook with the Farm Kitchen team, or bring the children to meet the animals

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Photographs by Mark Anthony Fox and Felix Brüggemann

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